Where was Murugan, Verma asked. Murugan said he saw them off at Nalini's Villivakkam house and left for the hideout in Porur, where Jayakumar was waiting with Peraribalan. The two of them in custody confirmed the same.[13]

Sivarasan, Shubha, Nalini and Dhanu got out of a taxi at Parry's Corner. Haribabu was waiting there with a khaki-coloured envelope marked 'Poompuhar'. Sivarasan asked him what it was. Haribabu said it was the sandalwood garland he had bought an hour earlier from the state emporium named Poompuhar. Sivarasan handed the envelope to Dhanu. All five boarded a state transport service bus for Sriperumbudur. They reached their destination around eight in the evening.

The assassins gathered at the venue. The moment had come. It was time to make the final strike.[14]

Kaarthikeyan gathered all the key accused in the same room for a joint interrogation. All the officers were there to listen to how the final moments of Rajiv Gandhi's assassination transpired. Much to the SIT's surprise, none of the accused spoke until asked a question. Kaarthikeyan watched them for almost ten minutes; he had a few words with his colleagues but paid no attention to them. The accused sat motionless, unruffled. They were waiting for the next question. It was a game of nerve between the accused and the accuser.

Among the assassins present in the room, only Nalini had been present in Sriperumbudur. The others looked at her, but she kept mum. Murugan looked at her and nodded. Nalini took a deep breath and started talking.

Dhanu, carrying the garland, positioned herself around the VIP enclosure. Sivarasan and Haribabu were hanging around her. Sivarasan stood slightly away from them, posing as a press reporter. Nalini and Shubha headed for the women's enclosure and watched everything from there.